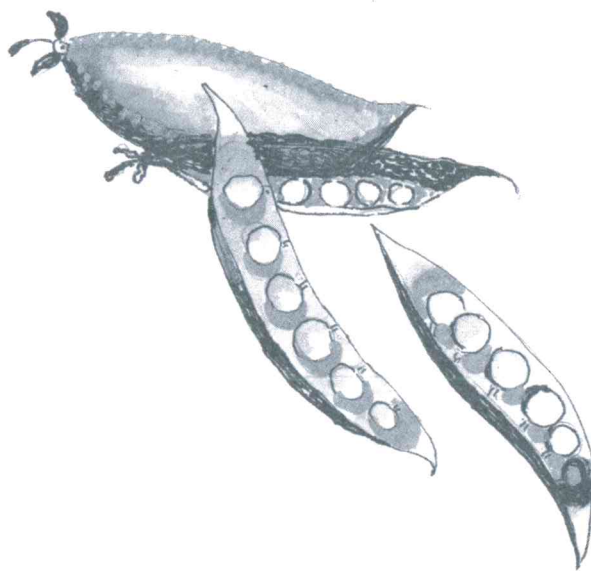


Cold Cream of Pea Soup with Mint

Serves 4



✧ This soup is bright green when freshly made. If you are preparing it more than a few hours ahead, don't add the yogurt until just before serving, or the acid in it will tend to discolor the puree, making the soup a darker, less appealing shade. For a smooth result, use thin-skinned fresh peas or frozen baby peas.

- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 1 medium onion, thinly sliced (1¼ cups)
- 3 cups homemade chicken stock (page 612) or low-salt canned chicken broth
- ¾ teaspoon salt, or to taste
- 1 cup loosely packed fresh mint leaves
- 1 10-ounce package frozen baby peas, not thawed, or 2 cups fresh peas
- 1½ cups plain yogurt (regular or nonfat)
- 1 tablespoon unsalted butter
- 1 teaspoon sugar
- ¼ teaspoon Tabasco sauce

Heat the oil in a large stainless steel saucepan until hot. Add the onion and sauté for 2 minutes. Stir in the stock and salt and bring to a boil over high heat.

Reserve a few of the mint leaves to decorate the finished soup. Add the remainder of the mint, along with the peas, to the boiling stock. Bring the mixture back to a boil (this will take 3 or 4 minutes) and boil vigorously over high heat for 3 minutes.

Immediately transfer the pea mixture to a food processor and process it until very smooth. (You can process this in one or two batches, depending on the size of your food processor.) Add 1 cup of the yogurt and the butter. Strain the puree through a fine strainer for a smooth soup. (If

not strained, the soup will have a slightly granular texture.) Mix in the sugar and Tabasco, cover with plastic wrap, and refrigerate until chilled.

At serving time, process the remaining ½ cup yogurt for a few seconds, until it is liquefied (it should have the consistency of a salad dressing). Divide the soup among four bowls and swirl 1 or 2 tablespoons of the yogurt over each serving. Decorate with the reserved mint leaves and serve.

Cold Sorrel Soup (Germany)

Serves 8

✧ *Potage Germiny*, the classic sorrel soup served in elegant French restaurants, is usually presented cold, with fresh chervil sprinkled on top. The sorrel, which is high in oxalic acid, goes well with the luxurious soup base, which is enriched with egg yolks.

Other more ordinary sorrel soups are made with sorrel, leeks, and potatoes, which are cooked with stock or water, then pushed through a food mill and finished with cream. *Germiny*, however, is made like a custard: the egg yolks are cooked in the hot broth. Straining the hot soup into the cold